

Brendan Mapes

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SUMMARY STATEMENT

Data analytics developer, social science researcher, and policy strategist with a track record of building systems to translate real-time data into mission-driven action. Experienced in leading service design teams and managing civic innovation projects. Skilled at turning complex research into meaningful insights for organizations to drive long-term, evidence-based social change.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Data Science & Analytics	Tools: R, Python, SQL, Oracle, Power BI, Stan, Tableau, RShiny, Qualtrics, Excel. Methods: Predictive modeling, statistical analysis, machine learning.
Research Methods	Quantitative research: Causal inference, survey design, Bayesian inference, regression analysis, mixed-methods study design. Qualitative research: Semi-structured interviews, focus group facilitation, UX/UI research, natural language processing, human-centered design.
Management & Strategy	Management: Agile workflow, client management, cross-functional leadership. Domain expertise: AI safety and ethics, civic innovation, social services, policy analysis, government relations.
Languages	Spanish: Full professional proficiency.

PROFESSIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Data Analytics Development Manager

The Office of Higher Education in Prison, State University of New York
New York, New York
March 2025-present

Leading the development of data management systems and analytics tools to equip the office to more consistently use timely, trustworthy data to inform HEP programming across the SUNY system. Facilitating and conducting mixed-methods research, in partnership with other state agencies, supporting the office's core mission – ensuring all incarcerated New Yorkers have equitable access to higher education during their incarceration and after their release.

Senior Analyst

Public Policy Lab
Brooklyn, NY
January 2023-March 2025

Conducting qualitative research with stakeholders of all types, including elected officials, local government, and members of the public, to identify opportunities for improvements in the delivery of social services and programs. Leading project teams consulting city agencies and other social service providers on various aspects of their work, primarily to make their programs more equitable and accessible. Leading internal data analytics projects to drive updates to company practices on data collection, analysis, and reporting.

Data Analyst

Communities Speak
New York, NY
July 2022-July 2023

Managing the intake of survey data for the Communities Speak survey, which aims to highlight the needs of groups of New Yorkers that are typically overlooked in the city's policy making processes. Translating quantitative and qualitative data into digestible data visualization reports designed to inform policy makers and community-based organizations providing social services. Responding to data requests from a variety of stakeholders, including policy makers, community-based organizations, and other academic researchers. Automating survey data intake from Qualtrics and the data cleaning workflow using R scripts.

Assistant Coordinator of Opioid Policy and Research

The Ohio State University Wexner Medical Center

Columbus, OH.

July 2019-July 2020

Coordinated various federally funded research projects and care innovation programs related to the opioid epidemic, across the medical center and university. Such projects included Project DAWN (Deaths Avoided With Naloxone), and the Healing Communities Study, which aimed to improve collaboration between city government agencies and community-based organizations in their drug use harm reduction programs. Collaborated with local community leaders who were also invested in improving Columbus' response to the opioid epidemic, and ultimately saving lives, by prioritizing a data-driven approach.

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Artificial Intelligence Ethics Consultant

Booz Allen Hamilton,

Washington, DC

January 2023-May 2023

Developing a framework for assessing and managing ethical risks related to artificial intelligence and machine learning tools, alongside Booz Allen Hamilton's digital ethics team, for both public and private sector clients.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Physics

Oberlin College

Concentration: Materials Physics, Minor: Spanish

Master of Arts in Quantitative Methods of the Social Sciences

Columbia University

Focus: Data Science

Thesis: A machine learning approach to seam-shifted wake: Using predictive modeling to better understand a newly discovered aerodynamic phenomenon acting on baseballs in flight.

Master of International Affairs

Columbia University

Concentration: Social Policy

Capstone: AI & Machine Learning Algorithms - Bridging the Gap between Policy and Practice.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE / COMMUNITY SERVICE

Spanish Translator

New York Presbyterian Hospital Vaccination Days

2022

Served as a Spanish language interpreter between patients and healthcare providers administering COVID-19 vaccines.

Baseball Coach

BedStuy Sluggers

2023-2026

Teaching fundamental baseball skills to 9- and 10-year-olds in Bed-Stuy, Brooklyn.